

Seminar 10 — Demographic and Migration Governance Cases

IR227 Politics of Change — TA slides (draft, editable)

July 2026

What you'll do in 90 minutes

[Bridge to seminar] *Take your assigned demographic-or-migration governance case. Apply the relevant frameworks (policy feedback, ACF, Hollifield's migration state, Freeman's typology). Reach a verdict. Close with a cross-transition reflection: what does this case imply for climate (Lecture 9) or AI (Lecture 11)?*

- Six cases, three pairs.
- Each group: 3–4 students, one case.
- Framework application, verdict, cross-transition reflection, plenary.

Three methodological points up front

1. Framework choice should follow case structure. Not every framework applies to every case.
2. Coalition analysis must specify actors and material/cultural interests.
3. Cross-transition reflection is the seminar's payoff and the bridge to Lectures 11 and 12.

Six cases, three pairs

Pair archetype	Case A	Case B
Demographic governance under aging	Japan	South Korea
Refugee/asylum governance under stress	EU CEAS	Australia OSB
Labour migration governance	GCC kafala system	ASEAN labour mobility

Within each pair: same archetype, different design responses, different coalition dynamics. (Goerres et al. 2021; Hollifield 2004; World Bank 2023)

Recap: the migration state

Framework: Hollifield's migration state

- 18th–19th centuries: garrison state and trading state, jointly (security + economic integration).
- 20th–21st centuries: **migration state** (security + economy + migration).
- Rights are the key instrument.
- The liberal paradox is structural, not contingent.

Recap: Freeman's typology

Framework: Four types of immigration policy

Each type produces a distinctive mode of politics. (Freeman 2006)

Concentrated distributive. Permanent-residence visas — client politics.

Diffuse distributive. Non-immigrant visas (tourism, study) — majoritarian politics.

Redistributive. Non-immigrant work visas; welfare for immigrants — interest-group politics.

Regulatory. Asylum claims — entrepreneurial politics.

Recap: cross-transition intersections

- Aging accelerates automation (Acemoglu-Restrepo: $\sim 35\%$ of cross-country variation in robot adoption explained by aging alone). (Acemoglu and Restrepo 2022)
- Automation reshapes migration politics.
- Migration governance shapes welfare-state sustainability (Ford-Sobolewska-Kootstra on UK + NL “heart-vs-head” channel for welfare chauvinism). (Ford et al. 2026)
- Welfare-state sustainability conditions political support for climate action.
- Climate-driven displacement increases migration demand.
- AI affects labour-market dynamics relevant to all of the above.

No transition can be governed in isolation.

Worked example: Japan — aging without effective immigration

- **Demographic profile.** 29% over 65 (2024); TFR 1.20 (2023); workforce shrinking 0.5%/yr.
- **Pension feedback.** Macro-Economic Slide mechanism (2004) cuts benefits gradually; structural reform politically very difficult. (Hong and Schneider 2020)
- **Aging-driven automation.** Among world's highest robot densities (IFR data: SK 19.7, DE 17.1, JP 13.8 per thousand industrial workers in 2014). (Acemoglu and Restrepo 2022)
- **Immigration.** SSW launched April 2019; July 2023 Cabinet decision expanded SSW-2 to nine industries; further expansion 29 March 2024. ~3% migrant share of total population (small by OECD standards).
- **Verdict.** Incremental adjustment lagging structural needs.

Worked example: EU CEAS — solidarity through coordination

- **Stress.** ~1m asylum applications in EU+ in 2023 (highest since 2015); Dublin secondary-movement challenge persistent.
- **New Pact on Migration and Asylum.** Adopted 14 May 2024; EIF 11 June 2024; implementation through June 2026. Solidarity mechanism (relocation, financial, or operational support); accelerated border procedures.
- **Externalisation.** EU-Turkey 2016; EU-Tunisia July 2023; EU-Egypt March 2024; Italy-Albania protocol Nov 2023 (operations Oct 2024).
- **Liberal paradox.** Treaty-level commitment vs member-state political pressure for closure. (Hollifield 2004)
- **Freeman's typology.** Asylum is regulatory (entrepreneurial politics). (Freeman 2006)
- **Verdict.** Sustained stress; incremental progress, fundamental tensions unresolved.

Worked example: GCC kafala — structural migrant dependence

- **Demographic dependence.** UAE ~88%, Qatar ~88%, Kuwait ~80%, Bahrain ~80%, Saudi Arabia ~45%, Oman ~45% migrant share of workforce.
- **Foundational institution.** Kafala (sponsorship) system tying residence and work authorisation to specific employer.
- **Recent reforms.** UAE Federal Decree-Law 33/2021 (effective Feb 2022; replacing 1980 Labour Law). Saudi Arabia LRI (4 Nov 2020, effective 14 March 2021). Qatar minimum wage QAR 1,000/month March 2021.
- **Implementation gap.** Reform announcements often outpace implementation.
- **Hollifield extension.** Rights-extension to migrants is constrained; employer-tied migration is the dominant institutional form. Freeman's typology developed for liberal democracies applies imperfectly. (Hollifield 2004)
- **Verdict.** Incremental reform from a baseline of tight employer-control.

Phase 1 — framework application (25 min)

Apply the relevant frameworks to your case:

1. Identify which frameworks apply (policy feedback, ACF, Hollifield, Freeman).
2. Apply each: what does it predict for your case?
3. Identify the coalitions (specifying actors and interests).
4. Where does the prediction match the evidence?

Output: a framework application + coalition analysis.

Phase 2 — verdict (15 min)

1. Reach a verdict on governance trajectory: succeeding / partially succeeding / contested / stalled.
2. Identify the binding constraint.
3. Walk from the framework analysis to the verdict.

Output: a defensible verdict, traceable to the analysis.

Phase 3 — drafting + cross-transition reflection (15 min)

Case: The diagnostic memo

- One paragraph: framework-and-verdict memo. Frameworks applied, coalitions identified, verdict, binding constraint.
- Two-to-three sentences: cross-transition reflection. What does your case imply for climate (Lecture 9) or AI (Lecture 11)?

Be specific. “Demographics affect everything” is not a reflection.

Phase 4 — plenary (25 min)

Within each pair: one group presents the framework analysis + verdict. The other group adds the contrasting point.

- Demographic governance: Japan vs. South Korea. Same archetype, different pace.
- Refugee/asylum: EU CEAS vs. Australia OSB. Same paradox, different navigations.
- Labour migration: GCC vs. ASEAN. Different non-OECD migration designs.

Then: cross-cutting reflection on cross-transition intersections.

Three things to take away

1. Demographic and migration transitions are politically structured, not technical. Coalition dynamics matter; framework analysis illuminates.
2. Cross-transition intersections are pervasive. No transition can be governed in isolation.
3. Governance creativity is needed where existing frameworks fail. Tuvalu Future Now Project, NZ-Tuvalu Falepili Union, EU New Pact, Australia OSB — each represents institutional innovation.

Tomorrow: AI and automation — where labour-market dynamics get developed and the regulatory-paradigm-divergence story returns.

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